QUICK GUIDE

SINE WAVE

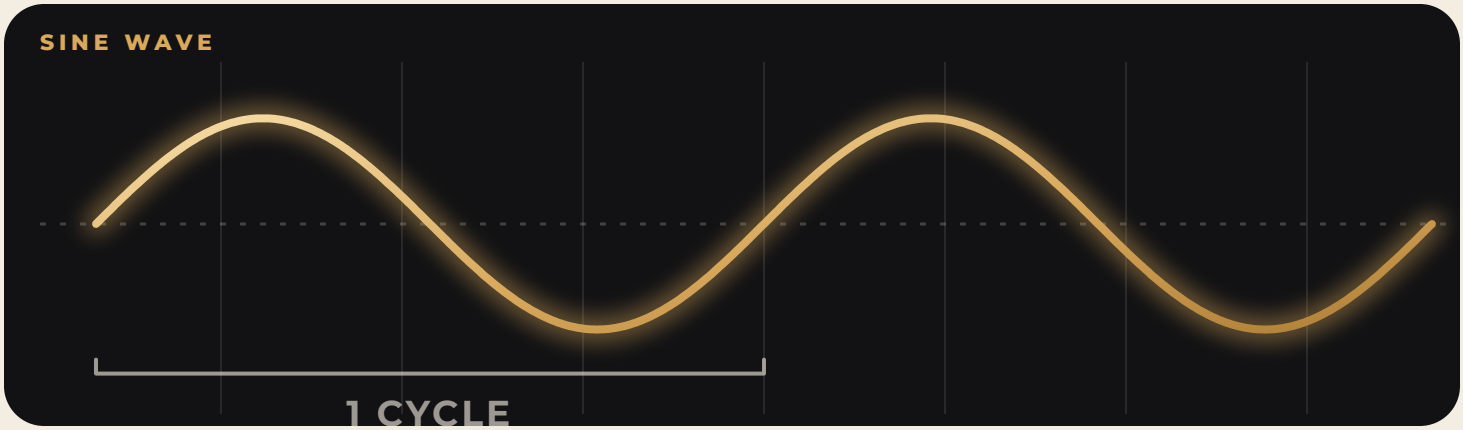
What it is, how to spot it and what to do with it.

WHAT IT IS

A sine wave is the smoothest repeating wave there is. It rises and falls in one clean curve and contains a single frequency, with no harmonics added on top.

HOW IT SOUNDS

Pure, smooth and clean. Think of a test tone or a deep sub-bass note.



01

ONE SMOOTH CURVE

Rises and falls evenly. No corners. No jumps.

02

ONE FREQUENCY ONLY

No overtones stacked on top. That's why it sounds so clean.

03

LIVES IN THE LOW END

Sub bass and clean 808 tails are close to pure sine.

DO THIS TONIGHT

Learn what clean low end sounds like on your own system.

- [ ] Play a sub-heavy track or a test tone on your gig system.
- [ ] Listen for where the low end gets clean, and where it gets lost.
- [ ] Keep it quiet. A loud pure tone can damage speakers.



PRACTICE & CHECK

SINE WAVE: YOUR TURN

WHERE YOU'LL MEET IT AS A DJ

- Sub bass and clean 808 tails are close to pure sine waves.
- Test tones and sine sweeps are used to check how a system handles low end.
- It's the building block: every other sound is a stack of sine waves.

QUICK CHECK

1. How many frequencies does a pure sine wave contain?

2. Which part of a track is closest to a sine wave?

3. Why keep a test tone quiet?

Answer key: 1) One. 2) Clean sub bass. 3) A loud pure tone can damage speakers.

REMEMBER

One frequency. One smooth curve. The cleanest sound you can hear.

YOUR NOTES

UP NEXT Square Wave

